

Best Ball Butts 2026: Week 4 outlook

As of 2026-09-30 (afternoon refresh). Weeks 1–3 are final and locked in; Week 4 starts Thursday. The numbers are the average of 12 season simulations (6 projection sources × 2 noise models, 8,000 seasons each) on the real schedule, best-ball scoring and Sleeper's 6-team bracket.

TL;DR

- **Noelle is a clearer favorite at 30.2%** (was 25.8%). She's 3-0 with the most points (626.4), 1st in 10 of 12 runs, and has a 72.9% chance at a bye.
- **Emma is the big riser, up to 2nd at 20.5%** (was 13.7%) after a league-high 229.2 in Week 3. Raghav and Ben are level behind her at 14.2%.
- **Raghav slips from 2nd to 3rd (14.2%, was 20.6%) despite going 3-0.** De'Von Achane tore his ACL, and Travis Etienne and Baker Mayfield are out through Week 6. Henry 7.3%, Lauren 6.7%, Conrad 5.7%, Avery 1.2% (last in all 12 runs).

Standings odds

#	Manager	Rec	PF	Title %	Range	Playoff %	Bye %	Prior edition (Sep 24)	Δ
1	Noelle	3-0	626.4	30.2	19–36	99.2	72.9	25.8	+4.4
2	Emma	2-1	619.3	20.5	10–29	95.4	41.3	13.7	+6.8
3	Raghav	3-0	530.9	14.2	6–32	93.6	36.8	20.6	–6.4
4	Ben	2-1	552.2	14.2	10–19	93.5	30.7	13.9	+0.3
5	Henry	0-3	502.2	7.3	5–11	64.3	4.7	9.9	–2.6
6	Lauren	2-1	550.4	6.7	3–13	77.1	9.9	7.9	–1.2
7	Conrad	0-3	475.0	5.7	2–10	53.1	3.3	6.6	–0.9
8	Avery	0-3	489.6	1.2	1–2	23.8	0.4	1.6	–0.4

What changed since last week

- **Week 3:** Emma beat Conrad (229.2–173.1), Raghav beat Lauren (179.1–150.1), Noelle beat Avery (231.3–153.0) and Ben beat Henry (179.4–167.7). Jahmyr Gibbs (Henry) had the top score of the week at 41.4, ahead of Brock Purdy (Emma) at 39.3 and Sam Darnold (Noelle) at 37.7.
- **Raghav's backfield took the biggest hits:** Achane is out for the season (ACL, IR). Etienne re-aggravated his hamstring and is out Weeks 4–6. Mayfield dislocated his throwing thumb and is out at least three weeks. Josh Allen's knee is a bruise, and he's expected to play.
- **Emma's offense went off:** Purdy 39.3, Bijan Robinson 35.3, Tyler Shough 32.8, Drake London 28.4. The Sleeper, ESPN and blend sources rate her at 23–29%; only the market source (about 10%) disagrees.
- **Other injuries:** Breece Hall (Henry) is out Week 4. Puka Nacua (Conrad) is likely out Week 4 with a groin injury, and surgery is still possible. Justin Jefferson and Mike Evans (both Avery) are Week 4 coin flips. Josh Jacobs (Lauren) is still on the exempt list, and a return around Week 9 is reported but not official.
- **Moves:** Lauren claimed Kirk Cousins for 125 FAAB (dropping Jaxson Dart), and he scored 28.2 in his first week. Henry swapped David Njoku for Keon Coleman.

Team by team

- **Noelle (30.2%):** 3-0 with the league's most points, and 1st in 10 of 12 runs. Daniels, Pierce, Charbonnet and Dowdle are all hurt, but Darnold (37.7) and JSN (35.4) more than covered for them.
- **Emma (20.5%):** 2-1 on 619.3 points, 7.1 behind Noelle. She rose the most this week (+6.8) on a four-way breakout at QB, RB and WR.
- **Ben (14.2%):** 2-1 and steady, level with Raghav and 3rd in 10 of 12 runs. Stevenson won back the lead snap share from Henderson (52% to 37%), and Waddle's walking boot is reported as precautionary.
- **Raghav (14.2%):** 3-0 but only 5th in points. With Achane, Etienne and Mayfield all out, his record is doing the work: with the record removed he'd be 4th at 11.5%. Only the market source still rates him 1st, at 29–32%.
- **Henry (7.3%):** 0-3 despite Gibbs's 41.4 and a 167.7-point loss by 11.6. Hall misses Week 4, and Reed (to Week 12) and A.J. Brown (to Week 7) are still out.

- **Conrad (5.7%):** 0-3 with the fewest points (475.0). Nacua and Coleman are hurt, but with the record removed he'd rank 6th at 9.3%.
- **Lauren (6.7%):** 2-1, but only 7th with the record removed (5.5%). The Cousins pickup fixed her QB hole; Jacobs is still unavailable.
- **Avery (1.2%):** 0-3 and last in all 12 runs, with Jefferson, Evans and Okonkwo all uncertain for Week 4.

Data checks

- **D/ST scoring:** all 36 defense scores in Weeks 1–3 match a recount from Sleeper's raw stats (0 mismatches, 0 zero scores).
- **Data source:** rosters, byes and projections came through Raghav's gateway MCP (sleeper-draft__export_league_snapshot, sha256-verified). The direct-API fallback was not used.
- **Refresh:** this edition re-runs this morning's Week 4 brief on a fresh snapshot. No new games have been played, and injury news was rechecked with no changes, so the moves from this morning's numbers are simulation noise.
- **Caveats:** rosters are frozen from here (no waivers or trades). Week 4 game-time decisions are scored as partial chances: Okonkwo 0.5, Jefferson and Douglas 0.55, Evans 0.6, Collins and Coker 0.75. Timelines for Etienne, Nacua and Reed are conservative estimates with no official word.